Instructions

To successfully complete this assessment, make sure to follow these instructions:

- Carefully read and understand each question before answering it.
- Respond to ALL questions in the assessment.
- Explicitly display your work and outline the steps taken for each answer. Support your explanations and responses with examples to showcase a comprehensive understanding. Partial marks will be granted for accurate work, even if the final answer is incorrect.
- Take note of the indicated weighting for each assessment attribute, denoted in ‘Marking Rubric’ at the end.

Submission

- Submit your completed assessment online using the following guidelines:
- Name and save your files as "ICC104_PR2_LastName_FirstName"
- Utilize the Assessment Submission link available under the Assessment tab in the primary navigation menu.
- Access your Learning Facilitator's feedback through the ‘Marks’ in the Learning Management System (LMS) portal.

Learning Outcomes

This assignment covers the following learning outcomes in component ICC104:

a. Explain the concept of Cloud and the traditional deployment model for IT services.
b. Compare and explain essential characteristics of Cloud.
c. Outline and differentiate different service models of Cloud.
d. Explain and apply knowledge of various cloud deployment models and differentiate between them.
e. Describe the concept of resource pooling and virtualization in Cloud.

Assignment Overview

This assignment is designed to provide students with hands-on experience using a public cloud provider to deploy a WordPress blog site. By following these steps, students will gain practical knowledge of setting up cloud-hosted applications and understanding cloud provider offerings, including cost management, virtual resources, and platform navigation.

Project Overview

The assignment includes deploying a WordPress site on any public cloud provider (e.g., AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Microsoft Azure, or others). The WordPress site should be set up using a LAMP (Linux, Apache, MySQL, PHP) stack. Use the provider’s free tier or initial credit, where available, for this deployment. The assignment consists of two main tasks:

1. **Report documenting the setup process, cloud provider selection, cost model, and overall experience.**
2. **Screencast video demonstrating the setup, including accessing the WordPress dashboard and the public blog view.**
3.

Important Note: Ensure that your implementation remains live until your assignment is marked (on or before **November 31**). You may then remove the deployment to avoid charges after the trial period ends.

Assignment Task 1 (Report):

Prepare a report documenting your experience deploying the WordPress blog. The report should include the following sections and have a word count between **1,500 and 2,500 words:**

1. **Introduction**:
    - Briefly describe the purpose of the assignment.
    - Explain the basics of using cloud resources for website hosting.
2. **Cloud Provider Selection**:
    - **Choose a Cloud Provider**: Explain your choice (AWS, Google Cloud, Azure, etc.) and describe any considerations, like free tier benefits, ease of use, or features.
3. **Project Setup and Process Documentation**:
    - **Account Registration and VM Setup**: Outline the steps you took to set up your account and start a LAMP stack VM instance.
    - **Deploying WordPress**:
        - Describe the LAMP setup process and the manual installation of WordPress.
        - Include screenshots to support your process (e.g., server setup, database configuration, WordPress setup screen).
4. **Cost and Resource Management**:
    - **Free Tier and Cost Model**: Discuss any cost management strategies you implemented.
    - **Cloud Provider Monitoring**: Describe any monitoring or management tools used to track your cloud resource usage.
5. **Reflections on the Process**:
    - **Challenges and Solutions**: Share any challenges you encountered and how you resolved them.
    - **Suggested Improvements**: Provide suggestions for making the process smoother or more efficient in the future.
6. **Comparison and Lessons Learned**:
    - Compare cloud hosting with traditional on-premises hosting.
    - Discuss what you learned about cloud resource management, virtual environments, and website deployment.
7. **Conclusion**:
    - Summarize the main findings and experiences from the project.
    - Highlight any key takeaways or recommendations for students new to cloud-based website hosting.

Assignment Task 2 (Screencast Video):

Create a screencast video (5-10 minutes) that shows your deployed WordPress blog and key stages of the project. The video should include:

1. **Cloud Provider Dashboard**: Show the cloud provider dashboard, including your deployed instance with IP address visible.
2. **WordPress Dashboard**: Access the WordPress admin dashboard.
3. **Public Blog View**: Show the live blog site, including a sample post or home page.
4. **Key Steps and Demonstration**:
    - Briefly demonstrate any key steps in setting up or managing the cloud instance, such as viewing instance details, monitoring, or accessing server resources.

Screen-casting Tool: Use a tool like Screencast or OBS Studio to record your screen. Ensure audio is clear and focus on essential steps and views only.